INGLÉS · NIVEL A2 · CUADERNO IMPRIMIBLE

Past Simple de "to be" en Inglés A2

Domina was y were: las dos formas del pasado de "to be", con afirmativa, negativa e interrogativa.

META DE LA LECCIÓN

Usar was y were para describir estados, ubicaciones y características en el pasado.

MODELO

She was tired. / They weren't at home. / Was the movie good?

Al terminar podrás

1. Usa was/were según el sujeto correctamente
2. Forma oraciones negativas: wasn't / weren't
3. Hace preguntas: Was she…? / Were they…?
4. Habla del pasado inmediato con confianza

CÓMO ESTUDIAR

Lee la explicación, reconstruye el mapa sin mirar, resuelve la práctica y corrige al final. Usa las tres pistas de audio de la lección web para imitar ritmo y entonación.

01 · COMPRENDER

La idea esencial

El past simple del verbo "to be" en inglés se forma con was (I/he/she/it) y were (you/we/they). Es la base para hablar del pasado y la primera forma verbal que debes dominar antes de aprender el past simple de otros verbos.

¿Qué son was y were en inglés?

Was y were son las dos formas del pasado del verbo "to be" (ser/estar) en inglés. Equivalen al español "fui/era/estuve/estaba" dependiendo del contexto. Se usan para hablar de estados, características, ubicaciones o condiciones en el pasado.

La clave es aprender qué pronombre va con cada forma: I, he, she e it siempre usan "was"; you, we y they siempre usan "were". Esta distinción es la base de todo el pasado simple en inglés.

Cuándo usar was y cuándo usar were

Usa "was" con sujetos singulares de tercera persona y con I: I was happy. / He was at school. / The weather was beautiful.

Usa "were" con you (singular y plural), we y they: You were right. / We were late. / They were at the concert.

Atención especial: "you" en inglés puede ser singular o plural, pero siempre va con "were". Muchos hispanohablantes cometen el error de decir "you was" por analogía con "él/ella era" "he/she was".

Pronombre	Forma pasada	Ejemplo
I	was	I was nervous before the exam.
He / She / It	was	She was at the office yesterday.
You	were	You were very kind to me.
We / They	were	They were excited about the trip.

Forma negativa: wasn't y weren't

Para negar, añade "not" después de was/were. En inglés hablado se usan casi siempre las contracciones: was not wasn't; were not weren't.

Ejemplos: The film wasn't very good. / We weren't ready. / I wasn't at home when you called.

Nota: en inglés formal (exámenes escritos, cartas) es aceptable usar la forma completa "was not / were not", pero en conversación la contracción es la norma.

Preguntas con was y were

Para hacer preguntas, invierte el auxiliar y el sujeto: Was/Were + sujeto + complemento? Esta es la misma estructura que en presente con "is/are".

Ejemplos: Was she tired? / Were you at the party? / Was the food good? / Where were you yesterday?

Respuestas cortas: Yes, she was. / No, she wasn't. / Yes, we were. / No, they weren't. En inglés no se repite el verbo principal en la respuesta corta.

Errores frecuentes de hispanohablantes

El error más común es "you was" — en inglés, "you" siempre usa "were", sin excepción. Esto incluye cuando te hablas a una sola persona: "You were great today!" (aunque solo le hablas a una persona).

Otro error es olvidar la contracción: "I was not there" es correcto pero suena rígido; "I wasn't there" es la forma natural. Lo opuesto también ocurre: escribir "wasnt" sin apóstrofo en exámenes — siempre incluye el apóstrofo.

¿Cómo se conjuga el verbo "to be" en pasado?

Solo tiene dos formas: "was" para I, he, she, it ("I was", "she was") y "were" para you, we, they ("you were", "they were"). En negativo: wasn't / weren't. En pregunta se invierte: "Was he…?", "Were you…?".

¿Cuándo se usa "was" y cuándo "were"?

"was" con sujetos singulares (I, he, she, it y nombres en singular): "The film was good". "were" con plurales y con "you" (you, we, they): "The films were good", "You were late". Es la única variación por sujeto del pasado de to be.

¿Cómo se hacen preguntas y negaciones con "was/were"?

Sin do/did: se invierte para preguntar ("Was she at home?", "Were they ready?") y se añade not para negar ("I wasn't tired", "They weren't here"). El verbo to be nunca usa el auxiliar "did".

02 · MAPA VISUAL

La regla de una sola mirada

FÓRMULA

Subject + was/were (+ not) + complement

Decide en este orden

1. I / he / she / it was (singular)
2. You / we / they were (plural, y también "you" singular)
3. Negativo: was not wasn't; were not weren't
4. Pregunta: Was/Were + subject + complement? Was she late? / Were they happy?
5. Respuesta corta: Yes, I was. / No, she wasn't. / Yes, they were.

Sujeto	Afirmativo	Negativo
I	was	wasn't
He / She / It	was	wasn't
You / We / They	were	weren't

Errores frecuentes

× "You was" "You were" — "you" siempre toma "were", incluso en singular.

× "Were I tired?" "Was I tired?" — I siempre usa "was".

× "I were not" "I wasn't" — recuerda la contracción correcta.

02 · MAPA VISUAL

Ejemplos de referencia

Tapa la columna en español, explica el sentido y lee el ejemplo en voz alta.

I was really tired yesterday.	Estaba muy cansado/a ayer.
She was at the library.	Ella estaba en la biblioteca.
They weren't home.	Ellos no estaban en casa.
Was the movie good?	¿Fue buena la película?
Yes, it was fantastic!	¡Sí, fue fantástica!
We were late for class.	Llegamos tarde a clase.
He wasn't at the meeting.	Él no estaba en la reunión.
Where were you last night?	¿Dónde estabas anoche?

03 · PRÁCTICA

De reconocer a producir

21 ejercicios imprimibles. Trabaja sin consultar las soluciones.

Reconocimiento: was o were

1. The party ___ amazing last Saturday. Opciones: was · were · is · are

2. My friends ___ very excited about the trip. Opciones: were · was · are · is

3. ___ you nervous before the exam? Opciones: Were · Was · Are · Did

4. It ___ really cold and rainy all day. Opciones: was · were · is · had

5. We ___ so young in this photo! Opciones: were · was · are · be

6. The meetings yesterday ___ very long. Opciones: were · was · are · is

7. I ___ very shy when I was a child. Opciones: was · were · am · be

8. How ___ the food at the new restaurant? Opciones: was · were · is · did

Afirmativo y negativo

9. The match _____ exciting, but the final result _____ what we expected. Opciones: was · were · is · are / wasn't · weren't · isn't · aren't

10. The students _____ really attentive, but the classroom _____ very comfortable. Opciones: were · was · are · is / wasn't · weren't · isn't · aren't

11. _____ you satisfied with the hotel? I heard it _____ that clean. Opciones: Were · Was · Are · Did / wasn't · weren't · isn't · doesn't

12. My parents _____ very strict, but they _____ always fair. Opciones: were · was · are · is / were · was · are · is

Un día en el pasado

13. Last Sunday _____ a special day for our family. My grandparents _____ at our house for lunch. The weather _____ perfect — sunny and warm. My cousins _____ there because they live far away, but we called them. The food _____ delicious: my grandmother's cooking _____ always the best. After lunch, we _____ all tired but very happy.

Escribe sin ayuda

14. I _____ (was/were) born in a small town. My parents _____ (was/were) both teachers. The school I attended _____ (was/were) close to our house — I _____ (was/were) never late. My best friends _____ (wasn't/weren't) from my neighborhood; they _____ (was/were) from another part of the city.

Producción escrita

15. Describe cómo eras tú de niño/a (carácter, actitud). Usa was con un adjetivo.

_____

16. Describe dónde estuviste el fin de semana pasado.

_____

17. Escribe una pregunta con "Were you…?" sobre el fin de semana.

_____

18. Escribe una oración negativa: algo que NO fue así en el pasado.

_____

Misión: El fin de semana pasado

19. Escribe una oración afirmativa sobre dónde estuviste o cómo estuvo algo.

_____

20. Escribe una oración negativa sobre algo que no ocurrió o no fue así.

_____

21. Escribe una pregunta para tu amigo sobre su fin de semana.

_____

04 · SOLUCIONES

Corrige y explica la regla

En respuestas abiertas, compara primero la estructura objetivo y después el vocabulario.

1. was — "The party" = tercera persona singular "was".
2. were — "My friends" = plural (ellos) "were".
3. Were — "You" siempre va con "were", aunque sea singular.
4. was — "It" = tercera persona singular "was".
5. were — "We" "were".
6. were — "The meetings" = plural "were".
7. was — "I" siempre usa "was".
8. was — "The food" = singular "was".
9. was / wasn't — "The match" = singular "was". Negativo singular: "wasn't" (was not).
10. were / wasn't — "The students" = plural "were". Negativo singular: "wasn't".
11. Were / wasn't — Pregunta con "you" "Were you⋯?" "It" (the hotel) = singular negativo "wasn't".
12. were / were — "My parents" = plural "were". "They" + "always fair" afirmativo: "were".
13. was / were / was / weren't / was / was / were — "Last Sunday" = sujeto singular "was". "My grandparents" = plural "were". "The weather" = singular "was". "My cousins" = plural negativo "weren't". "The food" = singular "was". "My grandmother's cooking" = singular "was". "We" "were".
14. was / were / was / was / weren't / were — "I" "was". "My parents" = plural "were". "The school" = singular "was". "I" "was". Negativo plural "weren't". "They" "were".
15. I was very shy when I was a child. — Ejemplo: I was very energetic. / I was a quiet child. / I was always curious.
16. I was at home all weekend. — Ejemplo: I was at my friend's house. / I was in the city center.
17. Were you at the party on Saturday? — Ejemplo: Were you at home yesterday? / Were you with your family?
18. The weather wasn't very good last week. — Ejemplo: The film wasn't very interesting. / We weren't ready for the test.
19. The party was really fun! — Ejemplo: The concert was incredible. / I was at the beach all day.
20. The weather wasn't great, but we still had fun. — Ejemplo: I wasn't tired at all. / The restaurant wasn't very cheap.
21. Were you at home all weekend? — Ejemplo: Was your weekend fun? / Were you with your family?

CIERRE

Escribe tres frases nuevas, léelas en voz alta y vuelve al mapa visual dentro de 24 horas.